



Notes

Jun 25, 2026

First "Hello" and user feedback for Allox allocation management

Invited Alex barchenko Jakub Skonieczny

Attachments 📎 First "Hello" and user feedback for Allox allocation management

Meeting records 📋 Transcript *(Some recordings unavailable)*

Summary

Meeting covered agency design workflow and allocation management via internal process explanations and strategic resource balancing.

Agency Workflow And Methodology

Agency design requires rapid onboarding and iterative refinement cycles compared to internal product development. Designers should manage projects holistically from discovery through execution rather than splitting roles between researchers and designers.

Allocation And Resource Management

The department lead manages designer allocation by aligning project needs with individual skills and institutional knowledge. Conflicts are mitigated by proactively analyzing scheduling overlaps before they materialize.

Performance And Work Balance

Objective performance results dictate project assignments rather than subjective

self-perception. Internal and client-facing hours are balanced through professional autonomy rather than strict micro-management.

Next steps

- ☐ [Jakub Skonieczny] Send contact list: Provide the list of key people involved in allocation to support further research. Include individuals such as Brandon Oxana Maria Kenny Kevin and K.
- ☐ [Alex barchenko] Schedule longer meetings: Arrange longer sessions for future interviews to ensure sufficient time for gathering insights from other stakeholders.

Details

- **Recording Access Procedures:** Jakub Skonieczny provides guidance on locating recorded meetings, noting that links may take time to appear after a session, and demonstrating that the easiest way to access them is through the calendar invite ([00:00:01](#)).
- **Designing in an Agency Environment:** Alex barchenko shares feelings of being new and overwhelmed, comparing current work to scientific fiction. Jakub Skonieczny explains that designers transitioning from product companies to agencies often face steep learning curves, as agency designers must rapidly onboard, understand, and deliver on new projects every six months, which is a different operational rhythm than internal product teams ([00:00:59](#)).
- **Agency Design Methodology:** Jakub Skonieczny clarifies that while agency processes may seem faster, they still involve discovery and research, albeit scoped down to deliver value more quickly, facilitating iterative refinement rather than long-term, traditional product development cycles ([00:02:59](#)).
- **Allocation Department Lead Role:** Jakub Skonieczny describes their role as department lead, responsible for managing the allocation of designers, ensuring project timing is correct, and aligning project needs with designer skills

(00:04:04). Jakub Skonieczny monitors potential projects via the "deals" pipeline, engaging in bi-weekly meetings to determine when to shift from potential to real allocation (00:05:17).

- **Manual Allocation Requests:** Jakub Skonieczny notes that they do not personally update the allocation system directly but submit requests to Brandon to handle changes. This process involves complex variables, such as whether a seat is billable or non-billable, which can change based on project type, client contracts, and the need for internal investment in new employees (00:07:20).
- **Proposed Allocation and Conflict Management:** Jakub Skonieczny discusses the "proposed allocation" feature used during the deal-scoping phase (L2/L3) to assign designers tentatively. They highlight the need for a mechanism to prevent scheduling overlaps, such as when a designer is needed for a new project before their previous one has concluded, as current processes require manual monitoring to identify and resolve these conflicts (00:10:13).
- **Managing Internal Versus Client Work:** Alex barchenko inquires about the ethical implications of assigning designers to full-time client work while potentially having them spend time on internal tasks. Jakub Skonieczny clarifies that client-facing time includes expected overhead, such as internal meetings, and that the company relies on an adult-level understanding of work commitments rather than micro-managing specific hours, noting that internal and client hours generally balance out over the course of a project (00:14:58).
- **Criteria for Designer Selection:** When selecting between candidates for a role, Jakub Skonieczny prioritizes personal knowledge of a designer's specific strengths and areas for growth, alongside logistical factors like upcoming vacations or project availability. They rely heavily on their own institutional knowledge and interview notes, noting that as the team grows, they may need to shift toward a more systematic approach that involves consulting with other managers (00:19:02).
- **Discrepancies in Self-Perception and Performance:** Jakub Skonieczny observes a common disconnect between a designer's self-perception of their skills and their actual project performance. Jakub Skonieczny prioritizes assigning designers based on their objective results and project needs rather than relying solely on the designer's own assessment of their expertise (00:23:33).

- **Role of Specialization within Workflow:** Alex barchenko asks if it is feasible to split a project between a researcher and a designer. Jakub Skonieczny explains that this model is generally ineffective because it disrupts knowledge continuity and relationship building with the client; therefore, they advocate for a holistic approach where individual designers manage the project from discovery through execution ([00:25:28](#)).
- **Conflict Resolution Strategy:** Jakub Skonieczny explains that they mitigate scheduling conflicts by proactively analyzing potential overlaps before they become reality, avoiding the need for a specific "backup" resource strategy. However, they acknowledge that external business needs, such as project priority shifts, can occasionally necessitate reassigning resources despite team friction, citing the example of the XWS project ([00:27:22](#)).
- **Future Stakeholder Interviews:** Jakub Skonieczny recommends that Alex barchenko consult with several key individuals to gain further insight into the allocation process, specifically naming Brandon, Oxana, Maria (Head of TPM), Kenny, Kevin, and K (Head of Sales) as primary contacts for various aspects of the business and resource management ([00:31:12](#)).

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Transcript

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00:00:01

Alex barchenko: Yeah, hope it will work because after after uh the meeting today with TPM, I also recorded the meeting but haven't find the file anyway.

Jakub Skonieczny: Oh, I can I can give you some tips. So,

Alex barchenko: Yeah.

Jakub Skonieczny: it takes some time to appear. That's one. And the easiest way to find it, I'll share my screen. I'll show you. Come on. And this is like literally the easiest way to find those links. Come on.

Alex barchenko: I did it through the

Jakub Skonieczny: Uh yeah. So yeah,

Alex barchenko: calendar.

Jakub Skonieczny: you just click on the My computer is lagging. I'm sorry. Come on. Work work. Doesn't work.

Alex barchenko: And yeah, I I I believe I got you. So, don't don't worry.

Jakub Skonieczny: Yeah, like like it's going to appear here anyways.

Alex barchenko: Uhhuh. Yeah. Nice.

Jakub Skonieczny: Okay, stop sharing because it's going to explode.

Alex barchenko: Nice.

Jakub Skonieczny: What is going on? Why is it so bad?

00:00:59

Jakub Skonieczny: Anyways, what's up? How can I

Alex barchenko: Uh yeah, I believe you saw you saw the film.

Jakub Skonieczny: help?

Alex barchenko: I'm not sure the correct translation in English, but it's like all together and right now uh it's like scientific fiction. uh about the Asian family and uh I feel I feel a bit like like that right now.

Jakub Skonieczny: I see. I see.

Alex barchenko: Uh but yeah everything is good in the same time I am excited because I really see here the great opportunity to grow as a specialist and that's that the nice thing to see uh but yeah

Jakub Skonieczny: Perfect.

Alex barchenko: but in the same time when people like came and okay I did this prototype in one week for XVS uh like request from the Google and like wow that's fast.

Jakub Skonieczny: I can I can tell you uh this is something I've heard in the past um from some of the designers that were working mostly for product companies. So like kind of internal teams I think similar to to you in Vodafone. They're basically saying all of the agency designers are different breed

00:01:55

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: because they basically going through on boarding to new company every six months and trying to understand everything, design it very quickly and leave. Um so so yeah I I I'm not surprised you would feel that way at the beginning. Hopefully you you'll catch up. It's a yeah it's a it's a very strong team very strong team of individuals here. So a lot at all you can learn from from many

Alex barchenko: Yeah. Yeah. That's that's important, you know, to find your exact way because uh everyone is different.

Jakub Skonieczny: people

Alex barchenko: For example, I had a conversation with Volmer who is also right now on boarding at Alux and he's like at the third day I just created the prototype for people to understand my vision and like I'm like wow that's that's not the thing I usually came up with at the first days but after analyzing I understand that he's actually from those agencies who's more focused on bring something at the table right here and then edit it iteratively.

Jakub Skonieczny: Yes.

00:02:59

Alex barchenko: uh I'm more doing a little bit more research phase first uh deeper but then trying to uh get in the product

Jakub Skonieczny: I mean uh so so I I know that's not the topic of this conversation but to me it's

Alex barchenko: uh

Jakub Skonieczny: a I think for agencies the process the same is just scoped down and using faster methods together but there's still discovery there's still research it it just doesn't takes three months it takes one week uh we

Alex barchenko: Yeah,

Jakub Skonieczny: don't focus on the whole scope for for forever we focus on something we can deliver and then the

Alex barchenko: right.

Jakub Skonieczny: future vision comes later you know like it's a I I always say there are only two ways to build products and I'm going to stick to this no one ever proved me wrong one is the traditional one the one that you are more used to so it's a longer discovery research and then based on those learning you build something that is probably safer and you're going to save a lot of time or there's a conceptual way where

you actually build it on deliver it and quick very get very quick value and then test it afterwards and refine.

00:04:04

Jakub Skonieczny: It's more expensive, but at the same time, you get way more way more values. It just all depends what you need

Alex barchenko: Mhm. That's true. That's true.

Jakub Skonieczny: really.

Alex barchenko: Um yeah. Uh I actually want to focus today on the alux uh allocation if you don't mind and I'm interested in hear more uh from from your uh feedback as a user of this uh functional as a manager let's say uh yeah can you just describe shortly like what is your role uh related to this functional and

Jakub Skonieczny: Mhm.

Alex barchenko: how do you usually uh allocate uh people

Jakub Skonieczny: Okay.

Alex barchenko: There.

Jakub Skonieczny: Um, well, I'm I'm a department lead, so I basically take care of the whole allocation of all the designers we have in the company. Um, so I'm just trying to make sure we have people ready and they they have everything they need to start the project and the timing is right. Uh, I need to make sure the skills are as as matching as possible, sometimes we cannot choose it, but like if there's a chance of like, oh, there's Alex available and Sylvia for example in like three weeks, right?

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Jakub Skonieczny: like which person would work better for this project or which one would like to grow in the areas that we're going to appear in the project right so I'm

always trying to make a match again we are agencies sometimes we don't have a pleasure to do that so then whomever is available lands on the project but that's kind of my mindset that if I can let's let's try to do this um my process of how I'm doing this is it's fairly simple so we have a channel communication from the bis bisops team and and sales in general about new potential projects even way before they are signed. So I know about potential projects that could start in August, right? And I just keep them in mind. There is this page deals I'm there usually most of the time added there. So I just keep track of them. We have a meeting twice a week. So where we discuss all the priorities when how close it is to sign when should we start thinking about real allocation rather than like potential allocation.

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Jakub Skonieczny: So basically once it get closer to signage or like it's it's signed or we have a green light to do this then I'm a fairly specific person because I remember every single person on the team where they allocated when they going to end their projects but if I wouldn't I would go to Alex people's page I would filter out by people and I'll basically look for opportunities who might be available at that time or if no one is available then what kind of shifts in the projects we need to do to make sure we stop this project right So as an example, there could be a person that is very long on one project and basically shared an interest. I want to jump to a different project because this one is already like I've been here for like two years and and and I would like to change, right? So if there is a chance and I usually know the context of the projects that person is on, if there's possibility, I'll probably do some shifts uh and and put that person on the new project, etc. So there's a lot of these like it's either finding who's available, who's the best fit, or do I need to be some more creative?

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Jakub Skonieczny: Do I need to do some more creative shifts to move people of the projects, different ones that like maybe less important or they kind of like on a a supporting phase where or maintenance phase where there's not a lot of design work, you know? So it's like all of these kind of elements to to understand who would be the best. Um I don't do changes in Alex.

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: So myself I basically go with a request of all the allocation changes to Brandon

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: uh and Brandon usually do it for me. I would rather do it myself because it's kind of an additional step and you know it's if it's going to be done very simple and very easy then why would I go to brand I can just do them myself. Um but that's how it is right now. I I I think why it is that way is because a the process is not the easiest. I mean I could learn it but it's like it's it's not the easiest.

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Jakub Skonieczny: The other one is there's a lot of like a should it be billable seat, should it be non-billable seat, uh all of these kind of like a nitty-gritty details that they changing from time to time. So I don't think there's like one language and one description of all of these to understand which flag assigned to which person. I think everyone has an understanding but there's always like a small nuance that you know defines whether we should do this or not. Like for example because non-buildable project means let's say you land on a Google project and the project is only contracted for part-time which means you you should be technically only paid for part-time and you're going to be paid only for part-time right but I will say yes but Alex is new to the company so I would like to put him fulltime so he can like fully focus on project and learn how to work with Google client right so in that case part-time would be billable and part-time would be non billable because it's our investment in you so you can be successful on the project, right?

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Jakub Skonieczny: So like we paying for the part-time even though you are on the on the client's projects. There's like one thing and there's like in that case how should we treat people on internal projects? Is it part-time? Is is it nonbale or billable? Because internal products are our budget and are our money,

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: right? So, it's like all of these kind of things. Is start a product nonbale or buildable? Probably should be nonbale. But there's no like a I think there's still a lot of things in flight and the more people have addit the more mess that's going to appear on Alex. I suppose uh it's just me guessing. Uh but again, I just don't do this right now. It's more like I just do all the coordination on Slack with people relevant on the project designer and then send the request to Brandon with all the dates when it should happen. Is it part-time, nonpartime, is it beatable, not buildable, send,

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: and he's making the updates.

00:10:13

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: That's it.

Alex barchenko: Yeah. But it's it's a good field field to explore. So you like talking about some kind of pre uh set for that. And how do you usually organize that? It only exists through the chat or you kind of having some documents that like after that when you already start to allocating the people you can uh like be relate to that uh conversation and check the information from there or how it works actually this like pre-stage and actually allocation

Jakub Skonieczny: Um there's no document there is a so I can tell you how I would love this to to to work and I think parachi it works that way in Alex but not always so

there is a feature of uh I think it's called proposed allocation or potential allocation I don't remember uh where you have deals and to each deal

Alex barchenko: Purple.

Jakub Skonieczny: you can say okay I think the best person will be this one so I'm going to add it as like a temporary allocated not really allocated it's not allocated it's like proposed allocation that once the project started that person will be assigned right so this is one way to track it of like if there is a deal I I don't remember in which stage it is available I think L2 because L3 L1 is discovery of the deal so it's like we literally just started talking with them there's it's like very low chance they going

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Jakub Skonieczny: to they're going to sign L2 is like it's a we are starting scoping it so L2 is called scoping we started scoping and understanding what they want. So like they more dedicated but we still don't know what we're going to be delivering. So it's kind of like I would say like 50 to 60% is going to be signed and then L3 is basically u it's like we closing the deal right I think it's called closing uh where the there's a high chance we're going to sign it like probably 70 to 80% and we already know what we're going to be delivering and we're trying to like a sign the contract and b start thinking about allocation who should be there. So this is the moment where we adding potential allocations. So I'm going through all the analysis of like who could be there,

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: who could be added etc. We are adding the potential allocation and once the project is convert like once the deal is converted into project so it lands into alloc then technically these people should be allocated the project the problem is there's many nuances to this of example I I can give you a specific example so we have a genpacked project that there is some discussions that it might not it might end uh I don't know if it's going to end or not like hypothetically

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Jakub Skonieczny: say it's going to end in August I don't know 15th okay let me check at the calendar if that's a because it usually ends on Friday and products are on Monday so let's say I'm looking at the calendar so let's say Genact will end on August 14th that's Friday but the other project

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: will most likely start August 10 right so technically I should have someone available from August 10th but let's say I'm considering Pav Grigg like who's on on genpack right now which means if I put him as a proposed allocation they're going to be there's going to be a conflict right because Jenack is not ended yet but then the seat started so there probably should be also some sort of like either information or prevention of doing these overlaps because technically you cannot be onto projects at the same time full-time that's just not possible right uh but it could happen so so so that's There is another one of um starter project. Believe it or not, it's very highly possible that designer won't finish their starter project.

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Jakub Skonieczny: Uh we try not to do this obviously, but it happened uh with Lee. Uh so Lee joined the game of June. Uh and after two weeks we had to take him to the Google project because uh no one else was available that then. Right. So again it's kind of again conflict right. So would be nice to have like a if we doing the allocation in the tool some sort of information that hey there's a conflict would you like to start a week after or would you like to uh short the the current seat to the week earlier and then start with the day that the project is actually starting. So so I'll probably think about it's like a it's it's a bigger connected ecosystem that has many things connected to each other. Uh, and there needs to be a way to like inform the user that hey, if you're going to do this, there's an impact on something else basically. Yeah, I don't know if I answered that answer.

Alex barchenko: Yeah, that's any any information is is useful.

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Alex barchenko: So, don't worry about that. Uh yeah,

Jakub Skonieczny: Okay,

Alex barchenko: I got it. I got it. This this is about the project conflicts. Let's imagine uh the different side of that. Not imagine the actually different side you know moral and law sides with the

Jakub Skonieczny: sure.

Alex barchenko: contract with the clients for an example or any other clients uh want an employee for the uh full-time for an example 40 hours uh but you

Jakub Skonieczny: Okay. Mhm.

Alex barchenko: understand that this uh employee actually available for some extra work I don't know five five hours a week um is this functional

Jakub Skonieczny: Mhm.

Alex barchenko: actually uh works for the company cuz you know here is some moral uh side of of this question. Is it like okay to say to the client that you are taking this employee for 40 hours but actually this employee only like kind of spent 35 and five more we doing for our uh rest proposes I don't know we have uh internally or whatever um maybe you can explain a little this

00:16:01

Jakub Skonieczny: Yeah,

Alex barchenko: side

Jakub Skonieczny: it's uh I'm probably not the best to say it how it works on the officially on the official level because I don't know how it's signed but a pink client

knows that we have internal meetings for example right so there's always going to be some hours if you full-time allocated that going to be spent on internal

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: meetings it's it's normal you have every company has uh Google like a company monthly meetings or you know team meetings and stuff like this I don't think anyone really look at this that way okay the same way we don't really as far as I know count uh days off etc and I also think Alex should be as simple as possible so for us as

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: an allocation we don't need to care about this right like treat as a part of part of part of work

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: I think what we should care about is is a person full-time allocated to the project yes or not and whether there's going to be some additional hours around it that they need to spend on meetings or like some logistical things internally that's different story.

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Jakub Skonieczny: Um because I also think that majority of those meetings are also like

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: optional like you've seen the thread on the on the design crew that some people cannot join because they have a client's work, right? So it's a we are all adults at the end, right? No one is also counting your hours. Is it actually 40 hours or maybe this week you're going to spend 38 and you're going to do 42 next week, right? Like no one is recounting those hours. We don't look at this that way. uh we want to make sure we deliver the work that is uh that's agreed on and do the best like I work way more than 40 hours trust me and I'm not expecting anyone to do the same but I do it's just like I'm just workaholic that is it is what it is right but at the end if I'll be allocated full-time then I'll be allocated full-time because that's was contracted and again we are

all adults so it's a like we're not going to force you to not work over hours if you really want to right so it's It's kind of like a let's try to make it as simple as possible.

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Jakub Skonieczny: It's basically is it full-time allocation, is it part-time allocation, is it 10 hours a week? If yes, that's it. That's what we charge client for.

Alex barchenko: Sure.

Jakub Skonieczny: Uh there are definitely some things in the contract that describes this or or cover this. So, but I don't think that's a I don't think that's a part of Alex to be to be honest. I think it's kind of like an unspoken rule that everyone everyone knows about.

Alex barchenko: Mhm. Got it. Got it. Thank you.

Jakub Skonieczny: It's a I can I can tell you a small ane anecdote.

Alex barchenko: Uh

Jakub Skonieczny: There was a client recently that basically started counting people being off and one of our leadership or like one of our exs went to the client and said, "Okay, so do you want us to also count over hours because you don't pay for them?" And the client just said, "Oh,

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: okay. Don't worry. It's fine." Right? So, it's this how it is.

00:19:02

Jakub Skonieczny: like they there are people that work over hours and no one cares about clients paying this. The same way they don't care about uh us paying for the hours they spend on internal meetings because it's it's actually it actually equals out

pretty much as a as a it doesn't equals out for one person but equals out as a as a whole project and the

Alex barchenko: Got it.

Jakub Skonieczny: team.

Alex barchenko: Got it. Thank you. Um okay there. Let's imagine you have two uh like folks two candidates who fits the position who can fit the position. How do you choose between them? What the main like characteristics?

Jakub Skonieczny: Mhm.

Alex barchenko: What the main things you have to think about to select one or

Jakub Skonieczny: Uh I think the most important is the personal element.

Alex barchenko: Father.

Jakub Skonieczny: So for most of designers I would say for all of them I know to the certain degree what are their best areas and worst areas in terms of like for example we have a very we have a startup project Bob's like this one uh where startups are super demanding like crazy demanding and they also like they they aim for like the most visual work they actually less care about like testing and research and they like super super into visuals and they kind of like you need to be like a very very strong founder designer mindset to be

00:20:25

Jakub Skonieczny: successful in those project otherwise you're just going to burn out or you're going to just be stressful all the time right so I know which designers could fit that role and which designers would struggle with that role or I know designers that would like to grow in this role and I see there's a space in the project where they can do this so it's all of these like if I have two people which one is the better fit in terms of the skill set in terms of the timing do they have holidays coming up or not uh how long the discoveries are they going to be available for the whole whole time like it's like it's many things to be honest uh yeah so I would say I would say this

Alex barchenko: But mostly what I from what I got you have this in in mind. So you know that personally who is who and the only things you are checking like the

Jakub Skonieczny: yes

Alex barchenko: holidays, vacations and so on to not like cover each other. Okay.

Jakub Skonieczny: correct if I don't know much then I'm asking their manager
Obviously, as we grow, it's going to be harder and harder to know everyone at the same level, right?

00:21:25

Jakub Skonieczny: Uh but if I don't know, then I'm just like covering that knowledge like I I'm trying to cover that knowledge. I also interview everyone when you guys join. So I even from interviews and all the notes, I know the profiles more or less. Uh I'm not saying someone is not going to excel in different area at certain point that would be amazing. But I also know about this because I know I track all of the projects. I know what's going on. uh which I know it doesn't help you because I'm just a person that has everything in mind which is not very systematic. Uh I don't know how that could work with engineering because there's like 100 engineers right? So for them then it's going to be difficult. I think for me if we're going to have 100 designers also going to be difficult. Um but as of today that worked like I have a I have a profile of all designers and I understand their strengths and weaknesses and I that's why I also really want people to like for example flag days off because I can go on a channel and see oh okay this person is going to be out so I I know this I don't need to go check it somewhere else right um I think in engineering they have a channel when they post requests and say hey so we have this project and this

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Jakub Skonieczny: project has this tech stack is there anyone that could fit that is uh

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: becoming available very soon or maybe we can take someone from different projects because they're not that demanding right now. So I think it scales with that level. Uh so it becoming like less of me knowing everything. It's just like me reaching out with the profile designs I'm looking for uh to other managers and leads and people that basically know people, right? Um but as of now that wasn't needed for me. Uh but I guess it at some point it will become needed here and and

Alex barchenko: Mhm. Got

Jakub Skonieczny: I can I can tell you one thing I'm not sure if this information could be shared that everyone

Alex barchenko: it.

Jakub Skonieczny: sees this. So I can tell you why uh there is a and I've observed this many times there is a difference between self-perception of where I am good versus where you actually are based on your performance that I've seen on the projects. Right?

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Jakub Skonieczny: So some people might might think, oh, I'm the best visual designer in the world and I know for a fact that's not true and you can have your perception however you want, but like I'm measuring this based off of the results on projects, right? So it's it's less about like, oh, I don't believe you. It's more about it's more about my measure so I know you'll be successful on the project rather than your perception of whether you think you're good or not. And if that will be put on the on the profile that everyone can read, there are going to be many people that disagree with this, right? It is what it is.

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: But like it's a I'm not trying to say someone is good or bad. That's not the case. It's more about the I see how the work is being done and I know what's needed for the certain projects and you know the the level might just not be there. So I would rather put someone that either that person wants to grow in this and there's space for this.

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Jakub Skonieczny: No problem. we're going to put you on this project. I'll go or I will just going to look for someone that is stronger in this area specifically rather than someone that thinks is stronger but it's not. Right. So it's like a yeah it's kind of like a what people think about themselves is very often different than what the actual truth is in the team composition.

Alex barchenko: Mhm. Mhm. Yeah. Got it. Got

Jakub Skonieczny: I mean there's still like I I know engineers for example they have a tech stack or like oh I know how to how to

Alex barchenko: it.

Jakub Skonieczny: uh write a code in I don't know Azure environment blah blah blah or like I know how to do react native right I think it doesn't apply it for designers we all know how to design in Figma uh I think most of us know AI tools with more or less but like we know all the AI tools there's no such thing as what framework do I use it's more about qualitative skills and an assessment based off of your performance because it's it's it's not just technical checkboxes, right?

00:25:28

Jakub Skonieczny: Um but still like we can have a oh this person has more preference in

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: research or this person has more preference in visual design or is doing a lot of motion. So there could be some sort of flags that maybe in the future will be helpful. I'm not sure. I'm just brainstorming.

Alex barchenko: Is it actually a case that you can like split uh the workflow for two designers and sign one for the I don't know research phase you know he's stronger at this and someone uh to proceed after that phase with the design.

Jakub Skonieczny: No. Uh we tried it. It just doesn't work because the problem is imagine you have a discovery that is uh let's say six weeks which is

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: long. We usually we usually do five weeks. There are sometimes products that are part four weeks which is even worse. Uh imagine you have someone that joins to do a research right and you need to share all the knowledge which you're probably going to waste like a week of the time that you don't really have.

00:26:25

Alex barchenko: Yeah.

Jakub Skonieczny: Uh there is a case and we've been doing this where you have two designers joining and one is doing research and leaving after

Alex barchenko: Yeah.

Jakub Skonieczny: research but then this one is still doing research with that other person but we

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: don't have a privilege of having a dedicated researcher plus uh we had an idea of oh maybe you should have a discovery team that just jumps on every project do the discovery and leaves to another one and do this but again the problem is the this team already builds a relationship with the client and they know how to work with them. They build the context of the project. They build all of the nitty-gritty details of what do what do not do like whom do you have access to. It's very hard to just share this whole knowledge to someone else and then be sure they going to succeed. Plus these people are not going to grow into discovery phase, right? Because they don't do them. So that's why you want to focus on like let's do holistical.

00:27:22

Jakub Skonieczny: If you're not comfortable with this, that's fine. We're going to support you. We're going to give you every everything you need to support you. But like we you should be just growing in this area if you're not comfortable.

Alex barchenko: Got it. Got it. Yeah. Thank you. Thank you. Uh the short one if you can like uh do you uh usually do some kind

Jakub Skonieczny: Yeah.

Alex barchenko: of in case of conflict you know that the person start the the project start uh 10 and the previous one uh finish at 30.

Jakub Skonieczny: Ah.

Alex barchenko: Yeah. Uh, do you usually do the backup person? Like for example, I wanted this one specifically, but if he can't, if I can't manage to shift the schedules, I'm going to assign another

Jakub Skonieczny: No. Uh,

Alex barchenko: person.

Jakub Skonieczny: no. Because I'm checking the conflict way before the project starts.

Alex barchenko: Mhm. Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: So, there's just no need for Becca because if they're going to say, "Oh,

00:28:07

Alex barchenko: Okay.

Jakub Skonieczny: that's not possible. We cannot do this." Then I'm going back. Okay. So, can we delay this project for a week? If not, then I'm just going to find someone else. So, there's no conflict per se because I'm trying to eliminate this early on.

Alex barchenko: Mhm. Okay. Yeah. Yeah. Thank you a lot for all your

Jakub Skonieczny: I mean the there are other conflicts. Uh so for example XWS is a very interesting project.

Alex barchenko: answers.

Jakub Skonieczny: It's a Google project but it's a it's a huge project. If you look at the XWS in in Alex it has like 30 something people. Okay. And within that project are like six or seven other projects.

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: Uh so it's a massive thing that's like very hard to track and we kind of treat it as like a stress test for all of the Alex functionalities because like the very big one but also one of in a way um and we had a situation very recently where there was a pal deck on on XWS and he was the I think the only designer there and they had kind of like a slightly slower period.

00:29:12

Jakub Skonieczny: Okay. So like he was he was also in the project for like a year. So he was the only person that knew all the context about everything and there was a ton of context. But at the same time, Pavl was the only designer that I could take into consideration because of the slower period that was on the other side of the Google rules which is real estate team because he was doing two other projects in the past for the real estate team and there was a new project that basically said we need someone that has a ruse experience. So I was okay the only available person is either me and I had I don't have time or Pablo Dimick right. So I went to the XWS team and say hey guys can we take pavo demick right and they said obviously no because oh we expecting some a big chunk of work coming like two weeks or something so that's that's going to clash etc. And that was a situation where I went to the to our our leadership and said, "Listen guys, we have this situation. We either take Pavo and sign the contract and then we will find someone in in some time for XWS

00:30:20

Jakub Skonieczny: because they've been always like it's it's a project that go for like three years, you know, they always had like this shift in timelines, etc. Or we leave PA,

we cannot take a new project, right? It's not me. you guys decide that's a business decision. That's not my department decision. And the decision was let's take Pavo off of XWS.

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: And the whole XWS team was pissed and it was on me to find the the replacement and get them out to up to speed very quickly. Uh so there are conflicts. Yes. And there's probably some communication connected to this that happens and we had like a lot of meetings to like go with everyone like oh guys just don't be mad at us etc. Uh but there are going to be this type of situations where we don't have anyone available and we need to make a business decision. Is it worth risking this project to take the other one or it's not worth it and we need to push back on the other one.

00:31:12

Jakub Skonieczny: Right? So yes,

Alex barchenko: Yeah.

Jakub Skonieczny: so you know there's also like some sort of a project priority based on the business impact and strategic impact.

Alex barchenko: Mhm. Yeah. Nice. A big a big machine but it have move straight.

Jakub Skonieczny: Yeah.

Alex barchenko: Okay. Got it. Got it. Yeah. Thank you a lot. I'm not gonna you more. I see we are a little bit out of time. Maybe I need to uh set longer uh meeting like next time with uh other users. But yeah, thank you a lot.

Jakub Skonieczny: I can I can tell you the best people to talk to,

Alex barchenko: Anyway,

Jakub Skonieczny: I don't know if you talk to them yet or not, are Brandon.

Alex barchenko: yeah, I already have uh him in the list.

Jakub Skonieczny: Okay, Oxana.

Alex barchenko: Oxana, not sure I have

Jakub Skonieczny: She's probably not doing this anymore, but she was uh I'll send you I'll just Let's do this. So, Brandon, obviously, Oxana.

00:32:12

Jakub Skonieczny: So, Oxana is again, I don't know if she still is because she was handing it off to Brandon, but very recently she was still doing this. She's basically she's ATPM but she was a dedicated person to handle engineering allocation. So much bigger team than the done design. So she's going to have a lot more to say.

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: Uh Maria uh she's a head of TPM uh and she

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: very often do the all exchanges for me believe it or not. Um and Kenny for sure and Kevin I would say these These are the people that are the most connected with allocation. And then if you want to have a perspective of um of the bisops team and like sales team that deals with all of the the the deals and projects, then I think the best one will be K. He's kind of uh don't say it, I said it, but he's the head of sales in a way. Uh all of the projects that are by Google, they brought by K. So that's uh he will be the best. He deals with all of these contracts and and all of

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: that.

Alex barchenko: Yeah. Thank you. Thank you for recommendation. I got a few people uh from the Donna Mcdana. Uh yeah,

Jakub Skonieczny: Mhm.

Alex barchenko: but your list is a little bit wider, I would say.

Jakub Skonieczny: Yeah, I think these are the best. Obviously, you can talk to Cameron and others, but like these are the I would say the key people that are related to allocation in

Alex barchenko: Mhm.

Jakub Skonieczny: general.

Alex barchenko: Okay. Okay. Yeah. Thank you. Thank you a lot for your time.

Jakub Skonieczny: Awesome. Yeah.

Alex barchenko: Yeah.

Jakub Skonieczny: If you need anything, let me let me know.

Alex barchenko: Sure. Thanks. Have a nice day.

Jakub Skonieczny: See you,

Alex barchenko: Bye.

Jakub Skonieczny: too.

Transcription ended after 00:33:56

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